Lab Exercise 15- Creating ConfigMaps in Kubernetes

In this lab exercise, you will learn how to create ConfigMaps in Kubernetes using different methods: from literal values, from a file, from an environment file, and from multiple files. ConfigMaps allow you to decouple configuration artifacts from image content to keep containerized applications portable.

Step 1: Set Up Kubernetes Cluster

Ensure you have access to a Kubernetes cluster. You can use a local setup with Minikube, kind, or use a cloud-based Kubernetes service.

Step 2: Create a ConfigMap from Literal Values

Create a ConfigMap named example-configmap with literal values:

```
kubectl create configmap example-configmap --from-literal=key1=value1 --from-literal=key2=value2
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl create configmap example-configmap \
--from-literal=key1=value1 \
--from-literal=key2=value2 \
-n myns
configmap/example-configmap created
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```

Verify the ConfigMap:

```
kubectl get configmap example-configmap -o yaml
```

You should see the example-configmap with the keys and values specified.

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl get configmap example-configmap -n myns -o yaml
apiVersion: v1
data:
  key1: value1
  key2: value2
kind: ConfigMap
metadata:
  creationTimestamp: "2026-02-28T17:26:46Z"
  name: example-configmap
  namespace: myns
  resourceVersion: "10715"
  uid: 44b4ceba-e320-4a52-b1fd-43d6927039f5
```

Step 3: Create a ConfigMap from a File

Create a file named **config.txt** with the following content:

```
key1=value1
key2=value2
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % echo "key1=value1" > config.txt
echo "key2=value2" >> config.txt
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```

Create a ConfigMap named file-configmap from the file:

```
kubectl create configmap file-configmap --from-file=config.txt
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl create configmap file-configmap \
--from-file=config.txt \
-n myns
configmap/file-configmap created
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```

Verify the ConfigMap:

```
kubectl get configmap file-configmap -o yaml
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl get configmap file-configmap -n myns -o yaml
apiVersion: v1
data:
  config.txt: |
    key1=value1
    key2=value2
kind: ConfigMap
metadata:
  creationTimestamp: "2026-02-28T17:27:52Z"
  name: file-configmap
  namespace: myns
  resourceVersion: "10769"
  uid: 467e4351-cddb-4c4c-907d-2a787a3cd367
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```

You should see the file-configmap with the content of config.txt.

Step 4: Create a ConfigMap from an Environment File

Create an environment file named **env-config.env** with the following content:

```
ENV_VAR1=value1
ENV_VAR2=value2
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % echo "ENV_VAR1=value1" > env-config.env
echo "ENV_VAR2=value2" >> env-config.env
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```

Create a ConfigMap named env-configmap from the environment file:

```
kubectl create configmap env-configmap --from-env-file=env-config.env
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl create configmap env-configmap \
--from-env-file=env-config.env \
-n myns
configmap/env-configmap created
```

Verify the ConfigMap:

```
kubectl get configmap env-configmap -o yaml
```

```
[mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl get configmap env-configmap -n myns -o yaml
 apiVersion: v1
 data:
   ENV_VAR1: value1
   ENV_VAR2: value2
 kind: ConfigMap
 metadata:
   creationTimestamp: "2026-02-28T17:28:56Z"
   name: env-configmap
   namespace: myns
   resourceVersion: "10819"
   uid: ca6eb25f-77ac-4910-a436-21834f913265
```

You should see the env-configmap with the environment variables specified in the file.

Step 5: Create a ConfigMap from Multiple Files

Create multiple files:

config1.txt with content:

```
key1=value1
```

config2.txt with content:

```
key2=value2
```

```
 mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % echo "key1=value1" > config1.txt
[echo "key2=value2" > config2.txt
```

Create a ConfigMap named multi-file-configmap from multiple files:

```
kubectl create configmap multi-file-configmap --from-file=config1.txt --from-file=config2.txt
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl create configmap multi-file-configmap \
--from-file=config1.txt \
--from-file=config2.txt \
-n myns
configmap/multi-file-configmap created
```

Verify the ConfigMap:

```
kubectl get configmap multi-file-configmap -o yaml
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl get configmap multi-file-configmap -n myns -o yaml
apiVersion: v1
data:
  config1.txt: |
    key1=value1
  config2.txt: |
    key2=value2
kind: ConfigMap
metadata:
  creationTimestamp: "2026-02-28T17:29:45Z"
  name: multi-file-configmap
  namespace: myns
  resourceVersion: "10861"
  uid: 09b20df2-1094-4a46-b9c3-9d32cb75fa88
```

You should see the multi-file-configmap with the content of both config1.txt and config2.txt.

Step 6: Use ConfigMaps in a Pod

Create a file named **pod-configmap.yaml** with the following content:

```
apiVersion: v1
kind: Pod
metadata:
  name: configmap-pod
spec:
  containers:
  - name: nginx
    image: nginx
    envFrom:
    - configMapRef:
        name: env-configmap
```

In this manifest:

- The Pod reads environment variables from the env-configmap.
- The Pod mounts the file-configmap at /etc/config.

Apply the manifest to create the Pod:

```
kubectl apply -f pod-configmap.yaml
```

```
[mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % vim pod-configmap.yaml
[mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl apply -f pod-configmap.yaml
 pod/configmap-pod created
 mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```

Check the status of the Pod:

```
kubectl get pods
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl get pods -n myns
NAME            READY   STATUS    RESTARTS   AGE
configmap-pod   1/1     Running   0          28s
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```

View the Pod logs to see the environment variables and file content:

```
kubectl exec -it configmap-pod -- printenv
```

```
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl exec -it configmap-pod -n myns -- printenv
PATH=/usr/local/sbin:/usr/local/bin:/usr/sbin:/usr/bin:/sbin:/bin
HOSTNAME=configmap-pod
TERM=xterm
ENV_VAR2=value2
ENV_VAR1=value1
KUBERNETES_PORT_443_TCP_PORT=443
KUBERNETES_PORT_443_TCP_ADDR=10.96.0.1
KUBERNETES_SERVICE_HOST=10.96.0.1
KUBERNETES_SERVICE_PORT=443
KUBERNETES_SERVICE_PORT_HTTPS=443
KUBERNETES_PORT=tcp://10.96.0.1:443
KUBERNETES_PORT_443_TCP=tcp://10.96.0.1:443
KUBERNETES_PORT_443_TCP_PROTO=tcp
NGINX_VERSION=1.29.5
NJS_VERSION=0.9.5
NJS_RELEASE=1~trixie
ACME_VERSION=0.3.1
PKG_RELEASE=1~trixie
DYNPKG_RELEASE=1~trixie
HOME=/root
```

You should see the environment variables and the content of the file-configmap.

Step 7: Clean Up

After completing the exercise, clean up the resources created:

```
kubectl delete pod configmap-pod
kubectl delete configmap example-configmap
kubectl delete configmap file-configmap
kubectl delete configmap env-configmap
kubectl delete configmap multi-file-configmap
rm config.txt env-config.env config1.txt config2.txt
```

```
HOME=/root
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop % kubectl delete pod configmap-pod -n myns
kubectl delete configmap example-configmap -n myns
kubectl delete configmap file-configmap -n myns
kubectl delete configmap env-configmap -n myns
kubectl delete configmap multi-file-configmap -n myns
pod "configmap-pod" deleted
configmap "example-configmap" deleted
configmap "file-configmap" deleted
configmap "env-configmap" deleted
configmap "multi-file-configmap" deleted
mohdanas@Mohds-MacBook-Air Desktop %
```